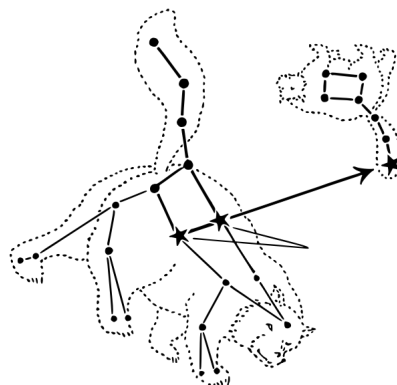


Celestial Navigation

A Recital of Original Compositions

Ezra Silver-Isenstadt, *Class of 2026*

Saturday, May 2, 2026 · 5:00 PM · Gildenhorn Hall



PROGRAM

Theme for the James Webb Space Telescope

Michael Hudlin, *conductor*
Kiran Kaur, *violin*
Hannah Choi, *cello*
Alexa Hunleth, *flute*
Nigel Smith, *clarinet*
Ryder Haines, *percussion*
Samwit Dangol, *piano*

Meadows

Hannah Choi, *cello*
Samwit Dangol, *piano*

A Midnight Daydream

Samwit Dangol, *piano*

String Quartet No. 1

Kiran Kaur, *violin*
Bianca Fuentes, *violin*
Xach Lee-Llacer, *viola*
Hannah Choi, *cello*

Flow

Samwit Dangol, *piano*

String Trio No. 1 in three movements

Kiran Kaur, *violin*
Xach Lee-Llacer, *viola*
Hannah Choi, *cello*

Ready for Today

Ezra Silver-Isenstadt, *guitar and vocals*
Max Isenstadt, *drums*
Carter Falkenstein, *bass*

The Silver Wedding

Hannah Choi, *cello*
Samwit Dangol, *piano*

It's Alright Now, Babe

Ezra Silver-Isenstadt, *guitar and vocals*
Max Isenstadt, *drums*
Carter Falkenstein, *bass*

Theme for the James Webb Space Telescope

Written for former artists-in-residence, contemporary ensemble Balance Campaign, this piece is my tribute to JWST and all who worked on it. I have been endlessly inspired by not only the fascinating, glorious, and humbling images returned from the telescope, but also by the resolve of humanity to explore the unknown with clear eyes.

String Quartet No. 1

I hadn't written any classical music before preparing my application to the School of Music. For the year before applying, I studied composition, theory, and orchestration under composer/arranger Scott Ninmer. This movement of a quartet emerged out of lessons on developing themes, passing melodies between instruments, and cultivating contrast.

String Trio No. 1

I wrote the first movement over a series of late nights. Picture me, encouraged by my roommate Oscar (Go Oscar!), leaping around the living room and kitchen at 1:00am, jumping on chairs, bellowing a melody with the nonsense syllables, "HUn ka CAH" (the cello plays this melody in the middle of the movement atop quick viola accompaniment).

Originally for string trio and tenor saxophone, the second movement enjoys gentle harmony and a subtle twang.

The third movement sees two melodies come together, the first introduced by the violin at the beginning of the movement, the second introduced by the viola in the middle. It makes reference to the Americana style.

The Silver Wedding

My wedding gift to my sister and brother-in-law. They are perfect for each other and I hoped to capture that in the music. The piano sets the occasion and the cello sings its heart out.

Meadows

It isn't always the case, but I wrote this piece linearly start to finish. A peaceful melody in 3/4 leads to a lovely stroll through a meadow. Though a brief 4/4 storm hits and it takes us some time to dry off, eventually the sun comes out once again.

A Midnight Daydream

At the fall 2022 72-hour challenge (deadlines help productivity), I attempted to capture the way the mind can wander wildly before falling asleep. One minute you're drifting off, the next you are winning an argument, the next you are lost at the circus, and so forth.

Flow

I had the first two measures in my back pocket for months before I could figure out what to do with them. I eventually realized that the free nature of the melody called for letting go of a strict adherence to any one time signature. From there I allowed the tune to flow. Two brief passages in 3/4 provide contrast in the form of both rhythmic predictability and a smidge of dissonance. This is probably my favorite piece I've written for piano so far.

Ready for Today

A few years ago I attended a concert at Merriweather Post Pavilion. Right before the show, I was offered an in-the-moment opportunity to perform Vienna by Billy Joel for the crowd of almost 20,000. But...I didn't know Vienna anymore and I had to say no.

Devastated the whole following week, I realized the only salvaging of the situation was turning it into art, and thus "Ready for Today" was born. In it, I reflect on opportunities both real and imagined that felt missed in the moment. Because I like this song, now I can be glad it all happened the way it did. Even more than the importance of preparing for unlikely possibilities, the lesson I take from this is that we have the power to turn our Ls into Ws.

It's Alright Now, Babe

Simple and sweet :)

ACKNOWLEDGMENTS

Thank you to Dr. Wilson, Johannes, Scott Ninmer, Athanasios (for recording), and the performers — Michael, Kiran, Hannah, Alexa, Nigel, Ryder, Samwit, Bianca, Xach, Max, and Carter. Thank you also to my parents and grandparents, my siblings, my siblings-in-law, my extended family, my friends and roommates, my classmates, all of my teachers, Clarice staff, and all who have ever supported me.